Phase 3: Leverage Points and Design Principles (Activity 9)

The Breakfast Paradox: IIIT Hyderabad Breakfast Mess System, Team Invictus

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Introduction

Phase 2 found that the Breakfast Paradox is a stable equilibrium, held in place by three confirmed structures: an automatic registration default with a narrow exit, billing at the booking and not at the meal, and a gap that the scan record and the operators' books both measure but that reaches nobody who sets the rules. On the kitchen side, registrations turn into a cooked first batch that any kitchen can top up and none can shrink. Activity 9 asks where this system can change. It delivers the Leverage-Point / System Intervention Map and the Design Principles, and hands seven principles and fourteen intervention points to Activity 10.

Claims keep the project's labels: confirmed (read off a record or seen on site), single-sourced (one account), candidate (an inference) and assumed. Depth is counted on Meadows' twelve places, with place 1 the deepest and place 12 the shallowest. Bakul has no records of any kind, so no Bakul effect is sized anywhere in this document.

1 Activity 9: Define Design Principles and Intervention Opportunities

Four methods run in turn: leverage points, read against archetypes and ranked; changes to rules, roles, incentives, information flows and processes; the design objective set against the case for the status quo; and fourteen intervention points. The map and the principles close the activity.

1.1 Identify Leverage Points

A lever is ruled out if it removes a mechanism that protects someone: resale, reuse of leftovers, the meals of 30 to 50 outside diners and about half of Kadamba's staff, the walk-in buffer, late and back-door service. The over-cooked first batch, repeated reheating and the bin protect no one and are fair targets. Feasibility is judged for a student team, which can propose, pilot and evidence a change but cannot enact a rule. High means a prototype or pilot with an actor already engaged, medium an evidenced proposal to an existing forum, low a proposal only, either because the holder is out of reach or because the lever rests on a fact nobody knows yet.

Rules (place 5) are used only where a rule itself changes. Place 9, on delays, would mean flattening the closing crest, which no lever attempts. Places 11 and 12 appear only as settings inside a deeper lever: cutting Kadamba's 70% ratio by decree would move the cost from surplus into run-outs at the crest, and the cancellation cap, raised from five to ten during a gas shortage and back at five now (single-sourced), changes only how many exits the default allows.

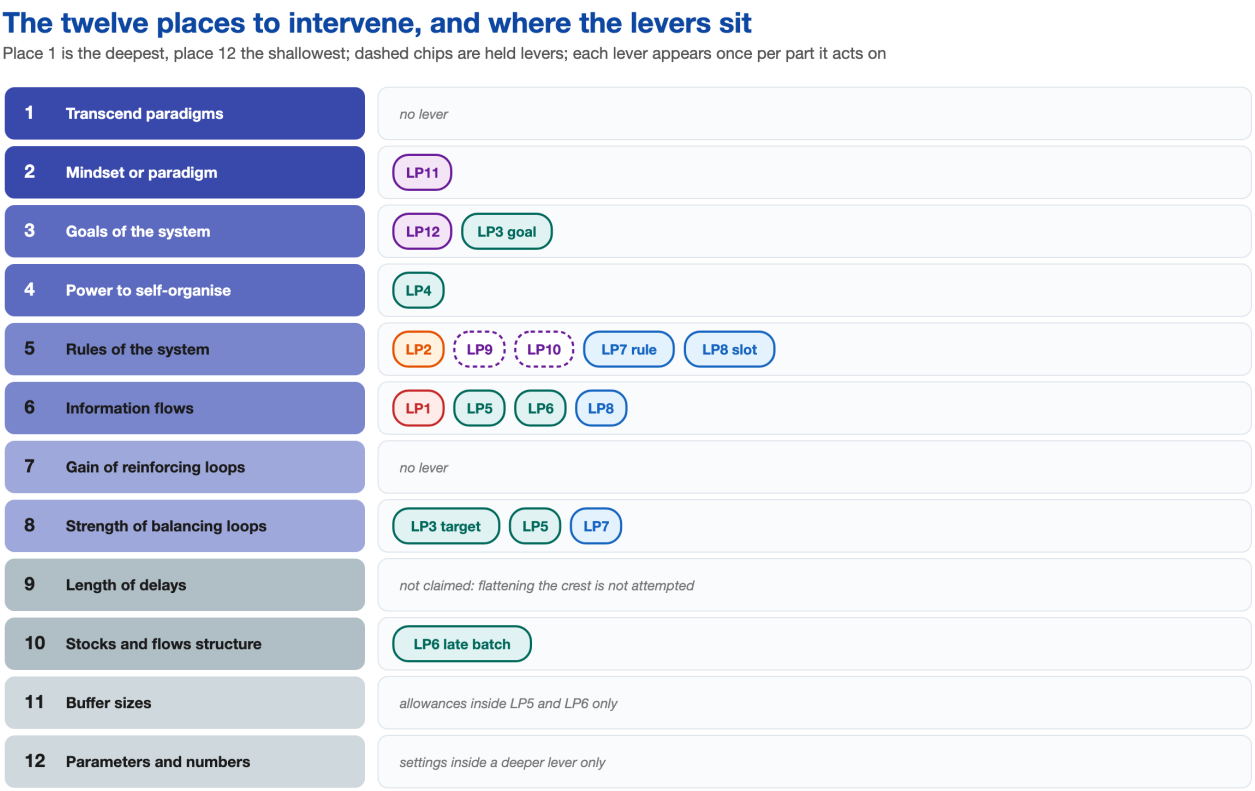


Figure 1. *The twelve places to intervene, and where each lever sits.*

Leverage point	Place	Holder of the power	Feasibility
LP1 Build the missing routes	6 (information flows)	CDS (scans), operators (books); receiver unnamed	High to prototype, medium to deliver
LP2 Change the breakfast default and its exit	5 (rules)	Registration rule owner (Mess Office or CDS, unconfirmed)	Medium
LP3 Operator goal: surplus is a cost	3 (goals); 8 for the target	Prism management; Bakul manager and firm	Low to medium
LP4 A standing operator forum that runs its own trials	4 (self-organisation)	Operators; CDS as convenor	Medium
LP5 Record-calibrated first batch with a daily learning record	6 and 8; allowances at 11 and 12	The operator	High (Yuktāhār), medium (Kadamba), unsizeable (Bakul)
LP6 Crest-aware top-up and a staged late batch	6 and 10	Operators; Mess Office or CDS for the window	High (Kadamba), low (Bakul)
LP7 A cost trigger for attention, carried on the oversight line	8; rule at 5	Escalation pathway; facility team	Medium, after LP1
LP8 Operator voice in the menu	6; slot at 5	Menu committee (unconfirmed)	Medium
LP9 A named owner of booked, cooked and eaten (held)	5	CFS and CDS	Low
LP10 What a booking costs: billing and payment basis (held)	5	Billing owner; contract holder	Low
LP11 Surface and test the governing mental models	2 (mindset)	Each belief's holder	Medium
LP12 Change the goal the system actually seeks	3	CFS and CDS	Low to medium

LP1: Build the missing routes. Of Kadamba's 32,162 breakfast registrations in April 2026, 37.1% were eaten.

Yuktāhār's September breakfast ran at 17.7 to 40.2% against 56 to 89% for lunch (confirmed). No route from any record to any rule owner exists, and Yuktāhār's own books disagree on 3 September, 77 eaten against 110. The fix is a standing breakfast view, the ledger, of booked, cooked, eaten and left over per hall, weekday and line, sent to the rule owner and back to the operators under one agreed definition of ”ate”. It also carries a weekly note of exams, events and holidays into the day-before planning meeting, which at Yuktāhār now arrives by word of mouth. It has to be blame-free and accept paper, because Yuktāhār has already dropped a commercial ERP system once (single-sourced). Delivery waits on a receiver, since two different people are on record as head of CDS. A bill line showing breakfasts paid for and not eaten is a student-facing variant, but without a way to respond it would only confirm that the charge cannot be avoided.

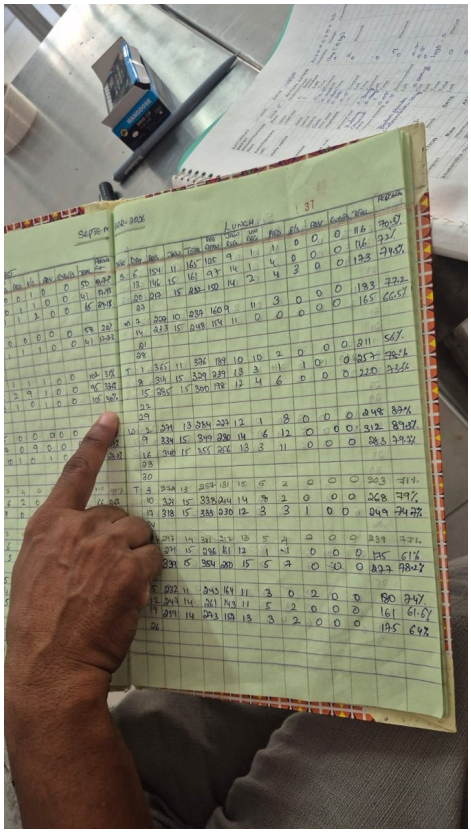


Figure 2. *The records already exist on paper: Yuktāhār's attendance register for September 2026, breakfast on the left page and lunch on the right.*

LP2: Change the breakfast default and its exit. Registrations hold at about 1,070 every weekday while turnout runs from 42.1% on Tuesdays to 27.3% on Sundays (confirmed). The four-day lead protects only dry goods, since Kadamba buys perishables the day before and Yuktāhār takes milk daily, and the Kadamba team has already pushed back on the cut-off (single-sourced). A student and operator coalition for a shorter lead is therefore the first shared interest on record (candidate). The lever is the default and its exit, not the cap. The options, lighter to heavier, are a one- or two-day lead, an evening-before confirm-or-skip that lowers the count, Sunday opt-in, and no registration while off campus. A lower count shrinks Kadamba's first batch only if it is the count the kitchen reads, and whether Skip Meal already lowers it is an open conflict. A skip must never cost a hall slot: one Kadamba respondent books the whole month because the hall fills up (L3b, candidate). The payment basis is unconfirmed for every operator. The Bakul manager says plates served and Kadamba's remark points to registrations (both single-sourced), so Bakul's position on LP2 is likely neutral or favourable if its account holds (candidate). If resale falls, it falls because the need has gone. No absorber is removed.

LP3: Operator goal: surplus is a cost. The purpose would move from ”cook for every booking” to ”feed whoever comes, at least cost” (place 3), with a numeric target inside L11 (place 8). Under the same rules the operators state different purposes. Yuktāhār names quality, less waste, lower cost, standardisation and profit. Kadamba cooks

to registrations ”because it is a responsibility and they are getting paid for it”. The Bakul manager's rule is ”there should not be a shortage of food, even if some wastage occurs” (all single-sourced), and at Bakul a run-out sends a complaint to the managing director while surplus stays silent, a kitchen-level case of a system that reacts only to what is loud (candidate). The fix is a wastage board, a target and a purpose stated by the operations manager, with the target anchored to the best recorded performance (Yuktāhār's rate or the institution's own goal), never last month's average, which drifts down. Smaller portions are the cheapest cut, so every target carries grams per plate, taste and run-outs (P7). A cost-per-line case can go to Prism's operations manager, who has not been interviewed.

LP4: A standing operator forum that runs its own trials. The operators already plan differently, and what separates them is practice more than rules: Yuktāhār's matching-week lookup (books photographed, confirmed), Kadamba's fixed ratio, Bakul's weekly judgement above a floor (both single-sourced). Yuktāhār's waste fell between August and December once weighing was made blame-free (single-sourced, with no before-and-after figures). Kadamba keeps gram standards but no learning record, and the Bakul operator believes Kadamba fills 90 to 95% where the records say 37% at breakfast (confirmed). The fix is a forum convened by CDS and hosted by Yuktāhār's two project managers, where each hall runs its own trial and the ledger shows the results. Swapping books alone is place 6, while a forum with the power to use the ledger to choose what works is place 4. What has to transfer is the preconditions: blame-free weighing, daily discussion and a purpose that treats waste as cost. Kadamba's layered chain adds a reprimand risk.

LP5: Record-calibrated first batch with a daily learning record. L11 closes at Yuktāhār, is a candidate instance bounded by a floor at Bakul, and is absent at Kadamba. Creating it at Kadamba is place 6 and strengthening it where it runs is place 8. Kadamba's 70% becomes 100% for biryani lunch (single-sourced), so the ratio follows expectation and no record. April turnout was 32.4% on the veg line and 48.5% on non-veg (confirmed), so the batch is about 2.2 times what was eaten on veg and about 1.4 times on non-veg (candidate arithmetic). The fix sets the batch as the gram standard times expected turnout per hall, weekday and line, plus a named allowance for outside diners and staff and a float for bonda, puri, vada and idli. It starts on the veg line with a one-page paper record read the next day. A 70% batch against about 398 eaten implies roughly 350 surplus portions (candidate), at odds with Kadamba's stated 5 to 10% waste, so the lever cannot yet be sized. Bakul's manager puts turnout at most around 60%, under his floor of about 70% (single-sourced), and the floor stays a named constraint until item-level records test it. LP5 is a quick fix, paired with LP1 against the L17 risk and with LP6 against run-outs.

LP6: Crest-aware top-up and a staged late batch. At Kadamba 26.5% of April scans land between 9:15 and 9:30, rising to about nine a minute by 9:29, and 9.2%, about 37 a day, arrive at or after 9:30, the latest at 10:07 (confirmed). The operator's estimate of about 150 diners in the last ten minutes overstates this and may drive the hedge (candidate). Yuktāhār projects from the first half hour, when only 15.3% of Kadamba's scans have arrived. The fix has three parts: a weekday arrival card telling the supervisor at 8:00 what share of the day has come (place 6); a late batch started just after 9:00 on that basis (place 10, because it changes when stock is created); and a grace period after 9:30, always paired with the late batch. The share seen by 8:00 runs from 13.5% on Sundays to 22.5% on Wednesdays, and the share after 9:15 from about 32% (Tuesdays, Wednesdays) to about 46% (Sundays), so one flat factor would misread Sunday and Wednesday by about a quarter (confirmed; used as factors, candidate). Nothing here transfers to Bakul, where the manager puts his rush at 8:00 to 8:30 and aims to have food for about 50 at 9:20 (single-sourced). A Bakul top-up needs a phone call, cooking at Hafizpet and a drive of about 8 km, roughly 20 minutes if called early and 40 otherwise, and the end-to-end lead time has never been measured. There the lever is the size of the held reserve, a hedge and not an absorber (candidate), and the latest call that can still land, both set from measured data. LP6 is part of the quick fix.

LP7: A cost trigger for attention, carried on the oversight line. Menu fatigue was fixed through the Student Council, the Parliament and the CDS Committee (confirmed, L4), but the far larger breakfast gap never entered that pathway. The facility team tastes every Kadamba meal with two Prism staff (confirmed, observed) and never checks quantity. The fix is a standing threshold, such as cooked-against-eaten above a set level for several weeks, that sends the case to the Committee as complaints already do. It is anchored to the stated goal, lunch turnout or Yuktāhār's rate, never the hall's own past, and it reports run-outs alongside surplus. The cheapest carrier is one extra line at the tasting. Because an inspector recording quantity can look like an audit, a breach triggers a review and never a deduction.

LP8: Operator voice in the menu. Kadamba's uttapam, set dosa and upma waste most while puri, bonda, vada and

idli move well (single-sourced), yet students or the committee choose the menu, not the kitchen. The Bakul manager wants menu input, knows what sells (pav bhaji) and which pairings he thinks work (kachori with chole), but his view that students would eat more of familiar pairings is untested with residents (single-sourced). The fix is a standing operator slot at each two-week menu cycle to report item waste and run-outs. This builds the missing route L16, the quiet counterpart of L4. Operator input is read with consumption records and checked against residents' views: a voice, never authority.

LP9: A named owner of booked, cooked and eaten (held). Decision rights are split at least five ways, across registration, billing, menu, cooked quantity and the academic calendar (confirmed), and whoever sets registration and billing bears none of the cost they produce. A named owner, not a committee, would put the consequence where the decision is made and inherit LP1. Yuktāhār's Wastage Register keeper is a lighter version. The lever is held until the head of CDS is identified.

LP10: What a booking costs: billing and payment basis (held). Attendance-tracked billing ran during a gas shortage and some holiday and fest periods, and it worked (confirmed). Operators are paid monthly as a lump sum on plates, with deductions (single-sourced, noisy audio), but no contract has been seen and the basis may differ by operator. The lever is held because a billing change made blind to the payment terms could push the operator incentive the wrong way, and student reliance on resale income needs checking first.

LP11: Surface and test the governing mental models. The beliefs holding the default, the fixed ratio and the unrouted gap in place sit at the base of the Iceberg chains, and nobody can change them for someone else. Eight meet a record that does not fit. The four Bakul beliefs meet none yet, so a test record is named for each.

Belief (holder, confidence)	What the record shows	Sign of a shift
The registration count stands in for demand (administration; candidate)	Flat count against 27.3 to 42.1% turnout by weekday (confirmed)	Rule owner cites booked against eaten
”Attendance billing is for emergencies” (candidate)	It ran and worked in the shortage and some fest periods	Discussed for Sunday breakfast
”Cooking to registrations is what we are paid for” (Kadamba; single-sourced)	Yuktāhār plans the same booking from records	Batch set in expected eaters
”Breakfast is about 50%” (Yuktāhār site head; confirmed)	His register shows about 28%	Stated and planned figures match the register
”Student fluctuation is very high” (Yuktāhār; confirmed)	The weekday arrival profile is regular (projection candidate)	A staged cook is tried and tracked
About 150 in the last ten minutes (Kadamba; single-sourced)	About 79 scans a day from 9:20 to 9:29 (confirmed)	The supervisor's prior guess comes close
”We don't have any opportunity to nullify it” (students; confirmed)	The exit exists but is narrow	Skip use rises after LP2
”They are catching us” (Yuktāhār staff; single-sourced)	Dissolved once weighing was made blame-free	Sheets filled unprompted
At most about 60% come (Bakul manager; single-sourced)	No Bakul record. Test: Bakul scans	Batch follows Bakul's scans
Students skip for taste, menu or sleep (Bakul manager; single-sourced)	No resident asked; six students elsewhere cite late sleep most. Test: residents' reasons	Menu changes follow residents' reasons
Pairings, not dishes, are the problem (Bakul manager; single-sourced)	No item or pairing record. Test: cooked and eaten by pairing	A proposal arrives with figures
”There should not be a shortage, even if some wastage occurs” (Bakul manager; single-sourced)	No record of how often a smaller batch would run short. Test: a daily run-out record	Floor and reserve set from that record

Each session starts from the ledger, settles disagreements by the record, pairs advocacy with inquiry and points at specific anomalies such as 50 against 28. At Bakul, which has no record, one has to be built first. Effort goes to the actors already open to the data, and holders of tested views are made visible.

LP12: Change the goal the system actually seeks. The CDS poster gives the institution's goal as minimising food wastage through advance meal planning (confirmed). The goal it actually pursues is the registration count: students are billed on it and Kadamba cooks on it (candidate reading). The stated goal's measure is recorded and read by no one. The fix makes booked-against-eaten and cooked-against-eaten, per hall and line, the real indicators, read

with quality and run-outs, because a wastage goal alone could be met by running short. CFS and CDS carry this by restating their own goal and asking for its indicators. LP12 is the move from the registration count to cooked-against-eaten, and the other levers make that move possible.

Identify System Archetypes

Of six structures checked, only the first three read as present. Shifting the burden orders the whole set.

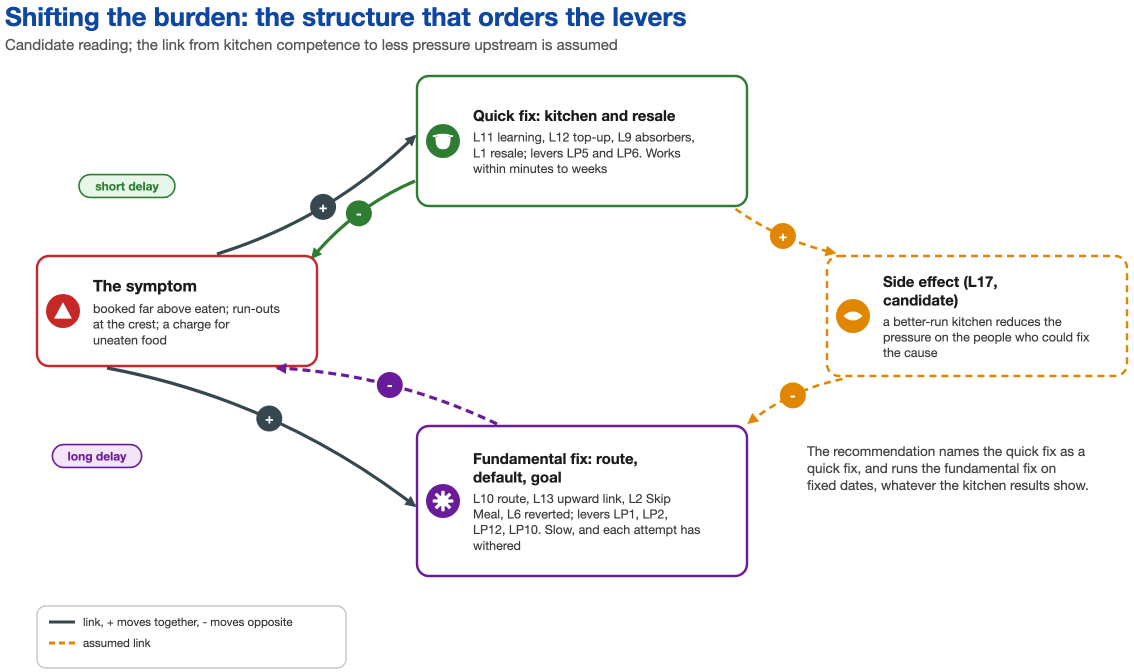


Figure 3. Shifting the burden: the structure that orders the levers.

Archetype	Loops and evidence	Confidence	Way out
Shifting the burden	Quick fix L11, L12, L9, L1; fundamental fix withered (L10 route, L13 upward link, L2, reverted L6); side effect L17. Resale replaces Skip Meal; attendance billing reverted (confirmed)	Candidate; the link from kitchen competence to less pressure upstream is assumed	Strengthen the fundamental fix (LP1, LP2, LP12, LP10), name the quick fix (LP5, LP6)
Balancing process with delay	L12 and L14: a 10 to 15 minute top-up against the crest; at Bakul a 20 to 40 minute drive and a held reserve	L12 confirmed; delays single-sourced; overshoot candidate	Be more responsive without over-correcting (LP6)
Fixes that fail	The reported December 2024 cap tightening; a candidate ratio ratchet on L14; the reheating branch of L13. No backfire observed	Candidate	Make the implicit target explicit (LP3, LP5)
Eroding goals	The stated goal against the count; ”this cannot be helped”; 50 against 28. No lowered target on record	Not established; a risk (assumed)	Anchor standards outside the hall (LP3, LP7, LP12)
Accidental adversaries	Operators and rule owner (L10, L16). No antagonism found	A risk if the ledger reads as an audit	Map the structure together (LP4, LP11)
Commons, or success to the successful	L3b: Kadamba full, Bakul under-registered; no Bakul or Palash records	Low, outside scope	None; LP2's hall-slot condition guards L3b

LP5 and LP6 are the quick fix. They are worth doing because students eat the food saved and they buy time, but the ledger has to label them as such: a better-run kitchen presented as the answer would end the search for the fundamental fix (the L17 risk). LP1, LP2, LP11 and LP12, with LP10 once released, form the fundamental fix, and LP12 answers the sharpest finding of the problem analysis, that the system chases the wrong goal. The one past change that pushed the wrong way is the December 2024 tightening of the cap to ease Mess Office workload, which narrowed the exit (single-sourced; effect on no-shows candidate).

Ranking: Depth and Feasibility

Depth combines place with role, so a fundamental-fix lever outranks a quick fix at the same place. Feasibility is judged for a student team over the weeks remaining.

Rank	Lever (place)	Role	Depth / feasibility	Gated on
1	LP1 (6)	Fundamental, enabling	High / high to prototype	A named receiver
2	LP11 (2)	Fundamental	Very high / medium	The ledger
3	LP2 (5)	Fundamental	High / medium	Lowering the kitchen's count
4	LP12 (3)	Fundamental	Very high / low to medium	CFS and CDS
5	LP3 with LP4 (3, 8; 4)	Links both	High / low to medium	Access to Prism management
6	LP5 with LP6 (6, 8; 6, 10)	Quick fix	Medium / high to low by hall	Waste base; Bakul records
7	LP7 (8)	Fundamental	Medium / medium	Facility team's parent body
8	LP8 (6)	Fundamental	Medium / medium	Records and resident views
Held	LP9 (5)	Fundamental	High / low	Head of CDS
Held	LP10 (5)	Fundamental	High / low	The plate basis

LP1 ranks first, though shallower than LP11, LP12 and LP2, because every other lever needs its input. LP11 is the deepest but needs the ledger first. LP2 is the deepest rule lever not gated on the plate basis. LP12 sits fourth because nobody who could carry it has engaged, and a goal without indicators or an exit does nothing alone. LP3 and LP4 carry the goal into the operator's routine, since Kadamba has the information but no reason or routine to use it. LP5 and LP6 are the fastest physical levers and land at Kadamba only through LP3 and LP4. LP7 outranks LP8 because it gives governance a response to cost. LP9 and LP10 are held, not dropped.

1.2 Explore Changes to Rules, Roles, Incentives, Information Flows and Processes

Type	Today	Candidate change	Lever
Rules	Automatic registration; five cancellations a month, four days ahead; back-door entry after 9:30 cannot be refused (single-sourced); billing at the booking	Shorter lead; evening skip that lowers the count; Sunday opt-in; no hall-slot penalty; consumption billing as already run; a grace period paired with a late batch	LP2, LP10, LP6
Roles	The facility team checks safety and taste only; nobody convenes operators or owns the outcome; the menu is chosen without operator input	A quantity line at the tasting; a CDS-convened forum; a named owner; an operator menu slot; CFS and CDS as carriers of the goal	LP7, LP4, LP9, LP8, LP12
Incentives	A non-eater pays anyway; Skip Meal returns nothing; recording is read as being caught; shortage is loud and surplus silent (candidate)	A later exit that removes the charge; surplus shown as cost; blame-free recording; a late batch or a sized reserve	LP2, LP3, LP5, LP6
Information flows	Records reach no rule owner; two definitions of ”ate”; the calendar by word of mouth; no kitchen-to-menu route (L16)	The ledger; a weekly calendar note; item waste into the menu cycle	LP1, LP8
Processes	Fixed 70% at Kadamba, a weekly judgement with a floor at Bakul, no record; the whole hedge cooked at the start	A calibrated batch with a daily record; an arrival card; a late batch after 9:00; safety steps unchanged	LP5, LP6

The widest rule change costs the kitchen least, because the four-day lead only protects dry goods. The incentive finding depends on how plates are paid. On registered plates, cutting surplus lowers cost while revenue holds: a route open now that closes if the rate is renegotiated, and turns harmful if surplus is cut through smaller portions. On served plates, the gain and the pressure to serve more both grow. If the Bakul manager's account holds, Bakul already absorbs the cost of uneaten portions to avoid shortage (candidate). P7's paired measures cover both cases.

The Natural Comparison

Kadamba and Yuktāhār share registration, billing and, as far as is known, tendered plate payment, yet Yuktāhār plans from records, re-cooks by run-out time and weighs blame-free on paper, while Kadamba cooks a fixed ratio. A learning practice is therefore possible under current rules.

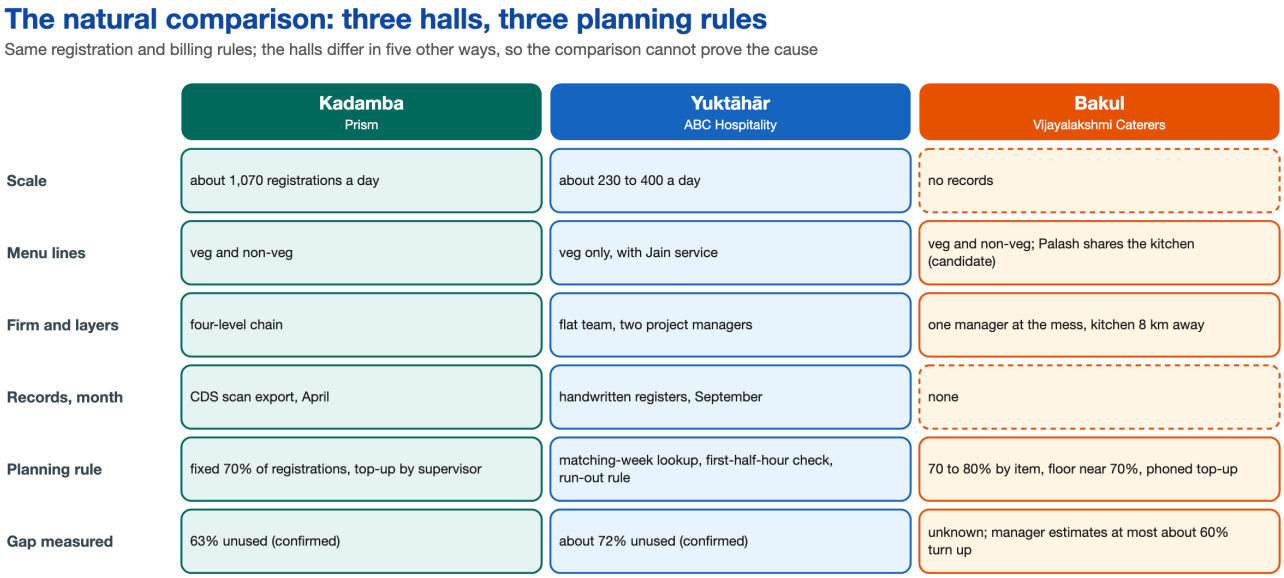


Figure 4. *The three halls side by side.*

The halls differ in five other ways, so the comparison cannot prove the cause. Two claims stay candidate: that the difference is goal and culture, and that LP3 through LP6 work without a rule change. The gap itself is similar at both recorded halls, so kitchen practice reduces waste and run-outs but only LP2, LP10 and the goal and belief levers move the booking. Bakul, a third regime with its own rival explanations (an off-site kitchen and a different payment report), needs its own records before it joins the comparison.

1.3 Develop Design Principles

The objective is a breakfast system where registration matches each student's intent, the kitchen cooks to expected eaters, and the cost of any gap reaches whoever sets the rules. It does not mean ending registration, resale or all waste. Registration gives the planning count, resale recovers money, and some surplus is the price of never running out. Over-booking and over-cooking should become noticed exceptions. The guiding idea from the archetypes is to change the architecture instead of competing at the kitchen layer.

The status quo persists because it pays each actor. The levers keep what each actor values (the seat, the resale, the absorbers, run-out protection) and change what drives over-booking.

Actor	What the status quo gives	Cost of change	Cost of not changing
Students	No decision; a guaranteed seat; resale income	A nightly decision; less resale	Paying for uneaten breakfasts (63% of Kadamba's April registrations); reheated food
Prism (Kadamba)	Revenue possibly on registered plates; few run-outs	Possible revenue fall; a daily record	Food cooked that no one eats; reheating
Bakul operator	No shortage, secured by a floor and reserve (single-sourced)	A check on the manager's judgement	Food held hot for hours, softening items such as aloo paratha
CDS	Low workload	A standing ledger; portal changes	A stated goal it cannot show it meets
Staff and outside diners	Food from surplus	Meals must be budgeted	Meals stay a by-product
CFS	A predictable budget	A budget that varies with consumption	Spending on food nobody eats

CDS and the Mess Office gain most from low workload and own the rules that the fundamental fix touches, so LP1, LP11 and LP12 have to reach them before any rule proposal.

1.4 Identify Potential Intervention Points

The fourteen intervention points follow one breakfast from booking to bin, then its governance. IP1 is the default, IP2 the cancellation exit and IP3 the count the kitchen actually reads.

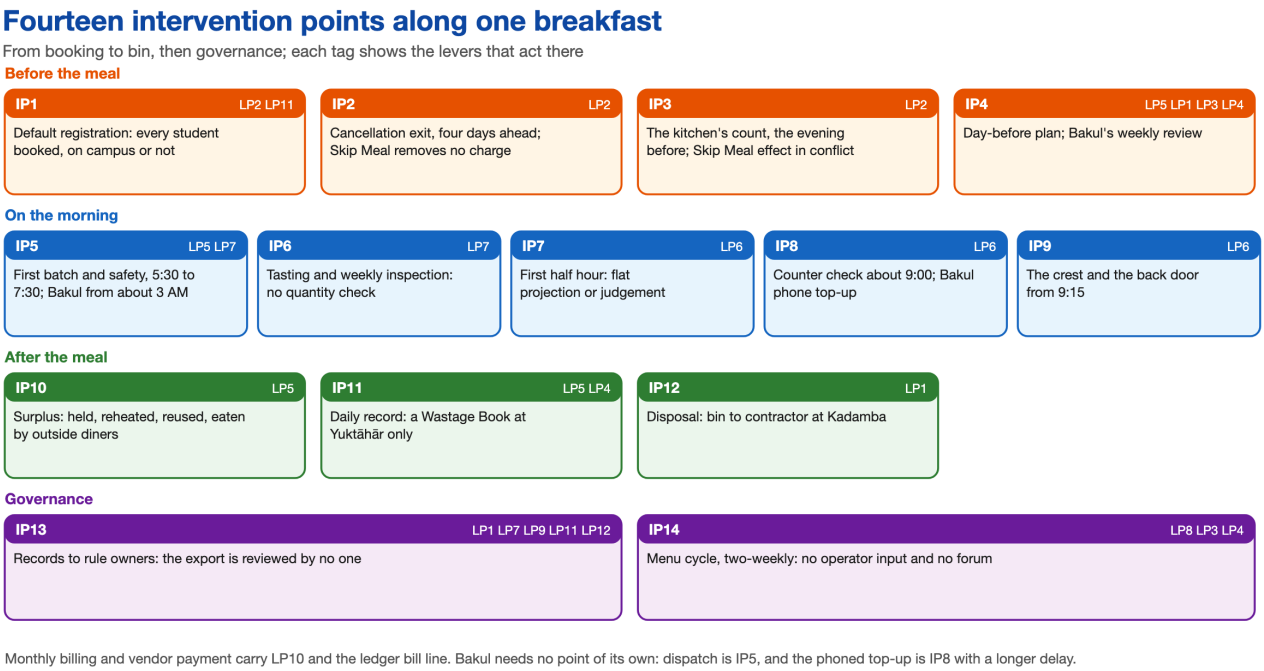


Figure 5. Fourteen intervention points, with the levers that act at each.

Sunday Breakfast: Where Three Levers Meet

Sunday has Kadamba's lowest turnout. A 70% veg batch is about 3.1 times what Sunday diners ate, against about 1.9 times on Tuesdays (candidate arithmetic), and Yuktāhār's Sundays run at 17.9 to 24.1% (confirmed). LP2 (IP1 to IP3), LP5 (IP4) and LP6 (IP8, IP9) bite hardest on Sunday, which makes it the natural first slice for Activity 10. The Bakul manager calls weekends ”very low” but gives no figure, so the slice stays specific to Kadamba's veg line.

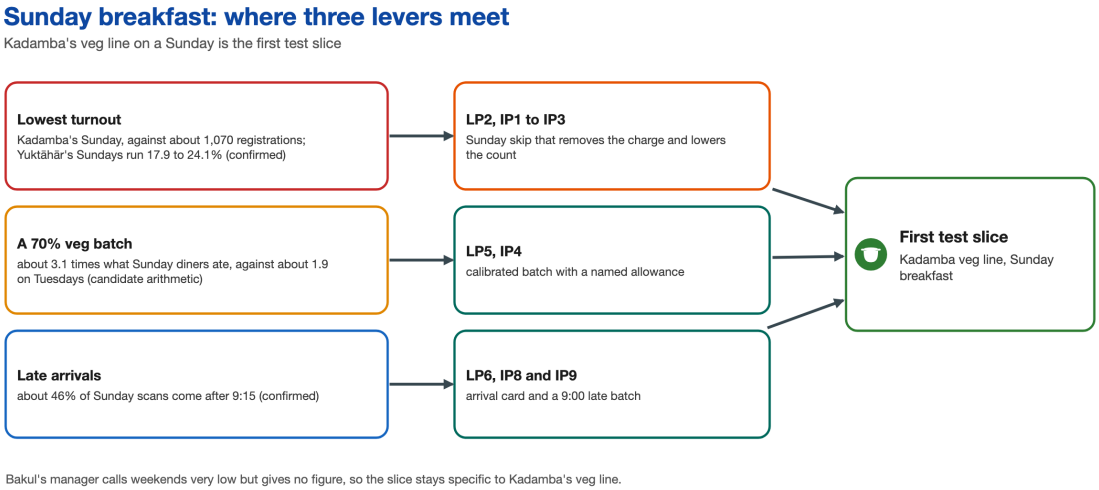


Figure 6. Where the three levers meet on a Sunday.

1.5 Deliverable 1: Leverage-Point / System Intervention Map

The map draws breakfast as one chain from the automatic default through the day-before plan, first batch, service and surplus to the bin, with records and money above and governance on top. Markers are coloured by place. Dashed red lines are routes that do not exist today and that a lever would have to build, and the dashed green learning link runs at Yuktāhār and is absent at Kadamba. Grey tags carry the intervention points.

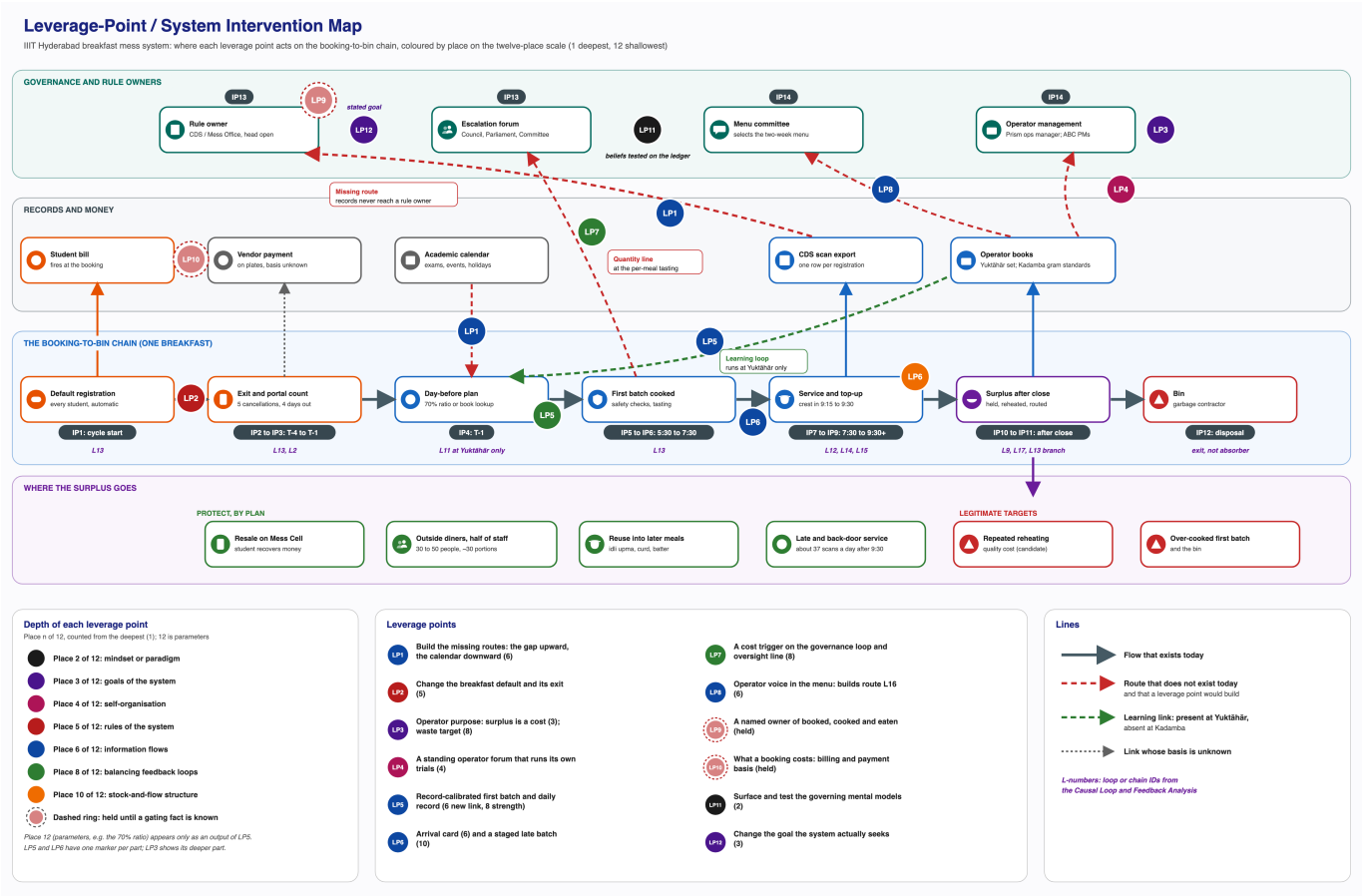


Figure 7. Leverage-point and intervention map for the breakfast mess system.

Every solid flow runs along the chain or up into a record, and stops there. The levers that build a route, set a goal, test a belief or convene operators sit on routes or bodies not yet doing that work, and the rule levers sit on the booking, the bill and the owner those routes would reach. The learning link, confirmed at one hall of three, is the only working feedback into the day-before plan.

Intervention point	Levers (place)	Holder of the power	Absorber check
IP1 to IP3 Default, exit, kitchen count	LP2 (5); LP11 students' belief (2)	Rule owner and portal owner; student representatives	Resale need shrinks; none removed
IP4 Day-before plan	LP5 (6 Kadamba; 8 Yuktāhār, Bakul); LP1 calendar (6); LP3 (3, 8); LP4 (4); LP11 operator beliefs (2)	Operators; academic administration via CDS; Prism management	Budget outside diners, staff and reserve
IP5, IP10, IP11 Batch, surplus, record	LP5 (6, 8); LP4 (4)	Operator	Keep safety steps and raw reserve; diners fed by allocation
IP6 Tasting and inspection	LP7 (8; 5 for the rule)	Facility team; escalation pathway	Adds no delay to safety
IP7 to IP9 Projection, top-up, crest	LP6 (6, 10)	Supervisor; Yuktāhār team; Bakul manager; Mess Office or CDS for the window	Keeps back-door service, made explicit; Bakul reserve sized
IP12, IP13 Disposal, records upward	LP1 (6); LP7 (8); LP9 (5); LP11 (2); LP12 (3)	CDS, receiver unnamed; CFS and CDS	The bin is a target

Intervention point	Levers (place)	Holder of the power	Absorber check
IP14 Menu and management	LP8 (6); LP3 (3, 8); LP4 (4); LP11 (2)	Menu committee (unconfirmed); Prism management	Removes nothing
Monthly billing	LP10 held (5); LP1 bill line (6)	Billing owner; contract holder	Check reliance on resale

Only LP5 and LP6 touch an absorber that protects someone, and both are written to keep it intact. LP5 budgets outside diners and half of Kadamba's staff by name and keeps reuse, the walk-in buffer and the top-up reserve. LP6 keeps them too and makes late and back-door service explicit with a late batch. LP2 and LP10 shrink resale by removing the need for it, not the market itself. LP1 records repeated reheating and the bin, LP3 through LP6 cut them directly, and LP2, LP10, LP11 and LP12 act upstream. No lever removes an absorber to create a signal, though that does not mean no lever costs anyone anything.

Stakeholder	Gains	Bears	Levers
Students	A later exit; less reheated food; fewer late run-outs; an honest bill	A nightly decision; possible loss of resale income	LP1, LP2, LP5, LP6, LP10, LP11
Prism (Kadamba)	Lower food cost; fewer late shortages	Possible revenue loss and rate renegotiation; a daily record	LP2, LP3, LP5, LP6, LP10
Kadamba supervisor, staff, storekeeper	A clearer late-batch rule; issues matched to a plan	A 9:00 cook decision, a daily sheet, blame risk, a varying batch	LP5, LP6, LP7
Yuktāhār operator	A menu voice; a better breakfast anchor	Hosting time; its head's figure set against his own register	LP4, LP5, LP8, LP11
Outside diners and Kadamba staff	Meals by allocation, not accident	Being squeezed if the allowance lapses	LP5
Rule owner (CDS or Mess Office)	The gap visible in its own terms	A ledger, a threshold to answer, portal changes, an ownership role	LP1, LP2, LP7, LP9, LP12
CFS and facility team	Evidence the goal is met; a remit reaching quantity	A less predictable budget; being seen as auditors	LP7, LP10, LP12
Bakul operator	A check on its judgement; a menu voice; no revenue loss from LP2 if paid on plates served (candidate)	Requests for records it may not keep; any rise in shortage risk	LP2, LP3, LP5, LP6, LP8, LP11

Each actor has a rational reason to keep the present arrangement, so resistance is expected and is not a fault to fix. Kadamba's operator loses most from LP2 yet is most needed for LP5, so at Kadamba LP3 and LP4 come before LP5. At Bakul the likeliest objection is to anything that raises shortage risk (candidate, held behind the unconfirmed plate basis).

1.6 Deliverable 2: Design Principles

Seven principles follow from the leverage points, archetypes and evidence, and every Activity 10 concept must pass all seven.

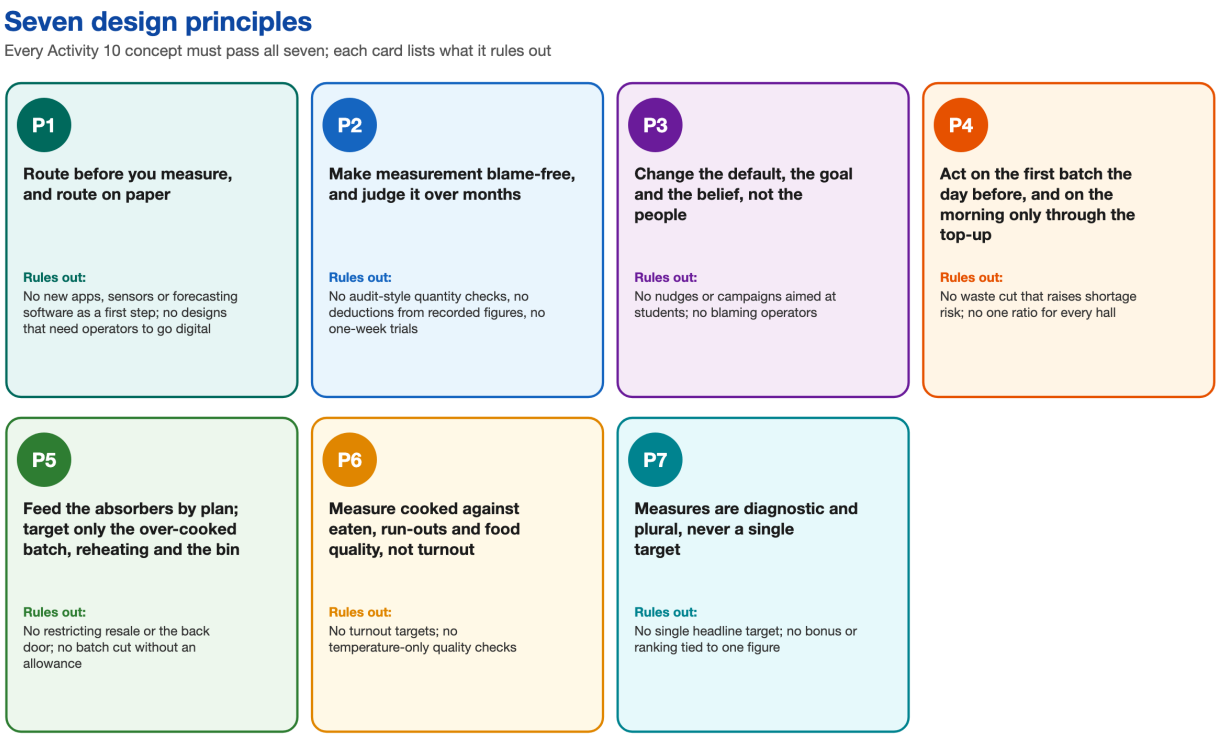


Figure 8. The seven principles, with what each rules out.

P1: Route before you measure, and route on paper. The scan export, Yuktāhār's books and Kadamba's own stated waste share already measure the gap, so connect them to the decisions that need them before adding any instrument. Yuktāhār dropped a commercial ERP over cost and staff readiness (single-sourced), so routes start from a book page and use existing channels: the daily meeting, the tasting, the menu cycle.

P2: Make measurement blame-free, and judge it over months. No recorded figure may justify a deduction against the staff who recorded it. Yuktāhār's weighing worked only once it was blame-free and discussed daily, and waste took from August to December to fall (single-sourced). One run-out after a smaller batch, judged over a week, would bring the hedge straight back.

P3: Change the default, the goal and the belief, not the people. Treat every actor as rational given its incentives and information. Students are registered by a default they never chose, operators run the only working balancing loops (L11, L12), and the institution states one goal and pursues another. Nudges and campaigns aimed at students, blaming operators, and changing the cancellation count while the default stays untouched are ruled out.

P4: Act on the first batch the day before, and on the morning only through the top-up. Morning levers work through smaller, later top-ups or, where a top-up cannot land in time, a sized reserve. No lever may cut waste by raising shortage risk, and scope stays per hall, weekday, line and, where records allow, item. Kadamba fixes the batch three and a half to four hours before the crest, Bakul can start cooking around 3 AM (single-sourced), and arrival curves and line turnouts differ widely. One hall's rule is not carried to another before that hall has records.

P5: Feed the absorbers by plan, name them as symptomatic outlets, and target only the over-cooked batch, repeated reheating and the bin. A concept that shrinks surplus must name who eats it and budget their meals. Thirty to fifty outside diners and about half of Kadamba's staff already eat this food (single-sourced), and calling their meals ”not wasted” would hide the gap again, the shifting-the-burden trap in miniature. Restricting resale, closing the back door and cutting the batch without an allowance are ruled out.

P6: Measure success as cooked against eaten, run-outs and food quality, not turnout. Success is the cooked-eaten gap, run-outs, food quality as eaten (holding time and texture as well as temperature and taste) and whether the cost reaches a rule owner. Falling waste with rising run-outs does not count. Some skipping is legitimate

(confirmed across interviews), and Bakul's food, held at about 60 to 72 °C, keeps its temperature while aloo paratha softens (single-sourced). No turnout targets, no waste cuts sized before Kadamba's 5 to 10% base is known, and no temperature-only quality checks.

P7: Measures are diagnostic and plural, never a single target. Measures are for learning and never for reward or penalty. Cooked-against-eaten always comes with grams per plate, taste and run-outs, because a kitchen held to one figure can meet it by cutting portions or letting the crest run short, and a vendor rewarded on it can meet it through the rate. The targets in LP3 and LP7 serve review and are not to be gamed. A single headline target, any bonus, deduction or ranking tied to one ledger figure, and waste figures reported alone are ruled out.